
ROLAND MEMISEVIC

CURRICULUM VITAE

EDUCATION

- Computer Science, PhD** Sep. 2003 – Mar. 2008
 University of Toronto, Department of Computer Science
 Adviser: Prof. Geoffrey Hinton
 Thesis title: *Non-linear latent factor models for revealing structure in high-dimensional data*
- Computer Science, Diplom (with distinction)** Apr. 1997 – Apr. 2003
 German equivalent of combined B.Sc./M.Sc.
 Department of Computer Science, Bielefeld University, Bielefeld/Germany.
 Advisers: Prof. Helge Ritter and Dr. Peter Meinicke
 Thesis title: *Unsupervised Kernel Regression for Nonlinear Dimensionality Reduction*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Qualcomm AI Research** since July 2021
 Sr. Director
- Twenty Billion Neurons** June 2016 – June 2021
 Co-founder, Chief Scientist (2016-2018), CEO (2018-2021)
- Department of Computer Science and Operations Research,
University of Montreal, Canada** Sep 2012 – May 2020
(adjunct 2016-2020)
 Assistant/adjunct Professor at MILA (Montreal Institute for Learning Algorithms)
- Department of Computer Science, University of Frankfurt** Jan. 2011 – Aug. 2012
 Juniorprofessor
- Department of Computer Science, ETH Zürich, Switzerland** Jan. 2010 – Dec. 2010
 Postdoctoral fellow
- PNYLab LLC, Princeton, USA** Jul. 2008 – Dec. 2009
 Research scientist
- Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto, Canada** Jan. 2008 – Jun. 2008
 Postdoctoral fellow
- Microsoft Research, Redmond, USA** Jun. 2007 – Sep. 2007
 Research intern
- Department of Computer Science, Bielefeld University, Germany** Apr. 2003 – Oct. 2003
 Research assistant

PUBLICATIONS

- Madan, P., Haresh, S., Ebrahimi, R., Panchal, S., Bhattacharyya, A., (additional authors), Memisevic, R. 2026
On Locality and Length Generalization in Visual Reasoning
ECCV 2026
- Haresh, S., Dijkman, D., Bhattacharyya, A., Memisevic, R. 2026
Notes-to-Self: Scratchpad Augmented VLAs for Memory Dependent Manipulation Tasks
ICRA 2026
- Ebrahimi, R., Defferrard, M., Panchal, S., Memisevic, R. 2026
On the “Induction Bias” in Sequence Models
ICML 2026
- Liu, L., Pourreza, R., Jian, Y., Qin, Y., Memisevic, R. 2026
From out-of-distribution detection to hallucination detection: A geometric view
ICML 2026
- Pourreza, R., Dagli, R., Bhattacharyya, A., Panchal, S., Berger, G., Memisevic, R. 2026
Can Vision-Language Models Answer Face to Face Questions in the Real-World?
ICLR 2026
- Liu, L., Pourreza, R., Panchal, S., Bhattacharyya, A., Jian, Y., Qin, Y., (additional authors), Memisevic, R. 2026
Enhancing hallucination detection through noise injection
ICLR 2026
- Bhattacharyya, A., Mahajan, S., Haresh, S., Yasarla, R., Pourreza, R., Liu, L., (additional authors), Memisevic, R. 2026
Streaming Interventions: Can Video Large Language Models Correct Mistakes as They Occur?
arXiv preprint
- Bhattacharyya, A., Xu, B., (5 additional authors), Sigal, L., Memisevic, R. 2025
Can Multi-Modal LLMs Provide Live Step-by-Step Task Guidance?
Neurips 2025
- Ebrahimi, R., Memisevic, R. 2025
Revisiting Bi-Linear State Transitions in Recurrent Neural Networks
Neurips 2025
- Khisti, A., Ebrahimi, R., Dbouk, H., Behboodi, A., Memisevic, R., Louizos C. 2025
Multi-Draft Speculative Sampling: Canonical Decomposition and Theoretical Limits
ICLR 2025
- Phan, B., Ebrahimi, R., Haresh, S., Memisevic, R. 2025
Delayed Attention Training Improves Length Generalization in Transformer–RNN Hybrids
Neurips Workshop on what transformers can(t) do
- Rainone, C., Bakker, T., Memisevic, R. 2025
Replacing thinking with tool usage enables reasoning in small language models
arXiv preprint
- Haresh, S. Dijkman, D., Bhattacharyya, A., Memisevic, R. 2024
ClevrSkills: Compositional Language and Visual Reasoning in Robotics
Neurips 2024
- Ebrahimi, R., Panchal, S., Memisevic, R. 2024
Your context is not an array: Unveiling random access limitations in transformers
COLM 2024

Panchal, S., Bhattacharyya, A., Berger, G., (8 additional authors), Memisevic, R. Live Fitness Coaching as a Testbed for Situated Interaction Neurips 2024	2024
Dagli, R., Berger, G., Materzynska, J., Bax, I., Memisevic, R. AirLetters: An Open Video Dataset of Characters Drawn in the Air ECCV Hands workshop 2024	2024
Bhattacharyya, A., Panchal S., Pourreza, R., Lee, M., Madan, P., Memisevic, R. Look, Remember and Reason: Grounded Reasoning in Videos with Language Models ICLR 2024	2024
Ling, Z., Fang, X., Li, X., Mu, T., Lee, Memisevic, R., Su, H. Deductive Verification of Chain-of-Thought Reasoning Neurips 2023	2023
Pourreza, R., Bhattacharyya, A., Panchal, S., Lee, M., Madan, P., Memisevic, R. Painter: Teaching Auto-regressive Language Models to Draw Sketches ICCV Workshops 2023	2023
Memisevic, R., Panchal, S., Lee, M. Decision making as language generation Neurips workshop on Foundation Models for Decision Making	2022
Mercier, A., Berger, G., Panchal, S., Letsch, F., Boehm, C., Bax, I. Memisevic, R. Does action recognition need pose estimation? Medium	2020
Materzynska, J., Berger G., Bax, I., Memisevic, R. The jester dataset: A large-scale video dataset of human gestures ICCV workshop HANDS 2019	2019
Mahdisoltani, F., Berger, G., Gharbieh, W., Memisevic, R., Fleet, D. The more fine-grained, the better for transfer learning NeurIPS Workshop on Modeling and Decision-Making in the Spatiotemporal Domain	2018
Goyal, R., Mahdisoltani, F., Berger, G., Gharbieh, W., Bax, I., Memisevic R. Evaluating visual “common sense” using fine-grained classification and captioning tasks ICLR workshop	2018
Ebrahimi Kahou, S., Michalski, V., Memisevic, R., Pal, C., Vincent, P. RATM: Recurrent attentive tracking model CVPR workshop BNMR	2017
Goyal, R., Kahou, S., Michalski, V., (9 additional authors), Memisevic, R. The “something something” video database for learning and evaluating visual common sense International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV 2017)	2017
Berger, G., Memisevic, R. Incorporating long-range consistency in CNN-based texture generation International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2017)	2017
Lin, Z., Courbariaux M., Memisevic, R., Bengio Y. Neural Networks with Few Multiplications International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2016)	2016
Krueger, D., Memisevic, R. Regularizing RNNs by Stabilizing Activations International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2016)	2016

- Im, D., Belghazi, M., Memisevic, R. 2016
Conservativeness of Untied Auto-Encoders
 Thirtieth AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2016)
- de Vries, H., Memisevic, R., Courville, A. 2016
Deep Learning Vector Quantization
 European Symposium on Artificial Neural Networks (ESANN 2016)
- Zhang, S., Wu, Y., Che, T., Lin, Z., Memisevic, R., Salakhutdinov, R., Bengio, Y. 2016
Architectural Complexity Measures of Recurrent Neural Networks
 Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS 2016).
- Kamyshanska, H., Memisevic, R. 2015
The potential energy of an autoencoder
 IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (PAMI).
- Konda, K., Memisevic, R., Krueger, D. 2015
Zero-bias autoencoders and the benefits of co-adapting features
 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2015).
- Konda, K., Memisevic, R. 2015
Learning visual odometry with a convolutional network
 International Conference on Computer Vision Theory and Applications (VISAPP 2015).
- Jean, S., Cho, K., Memisevic, R., Bengio, Y. 2015
On using very large target vocabulary for neural machine translation
 Annual meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2015).
- Konda, K., Chandrasekariah, P., Memisevic, R., Triesch, J. 2015
Real-time activity recognition via deep learning of motion features
 European Symposium on Artificial Neural Networks (ESANN2015)
- Michalski V., Memisevic R., Konda K. 2014
Modeling Deep Temporal Dependencies with Recurrent “Grammar Cells”
 Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS 2014).
- Konda K., Memisevic, R., Michalski V. 2014
Learning to encode motion using spatio-temporal synchrony
 International Conference on Representation Learning (ICLR 2014).
- Konda K., Memisevic R. 2014
A unified approach to learning depth and motion features
 Indian Conference on Computer Vision, Graphics and Image Processing (ICVGIP 2014).
- Memisevic, R. 2013
Learning to relate images
 IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (PAMI) Special issue on Learning Deep Architectures 2013.
- Kamyshanska, H., Memisevic, R. 2013
On autoencoder scoring
 International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2013).
- Memisevic, R., Exarchakis, G. 2013
Learning invariant features by harnessing the aperture problem
 International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2013).
- Bauer, F., Memisevic, R. 2013
Feature grouping from spatially constrained multiplicative interaction
 International Conference on Representation Learning (ICLR 2013).

Memisevic, R., Sigal L., Fleet, D. Shared Kernel Information Embedding for Discriminative Inference. IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (PAMI).	2012
Memisevic, R. On multiview feature learning International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2012).	2012
Memisevic, R. On spatio-temporal feature learning The Learning Workshop, Snowbird.	2012
Memisevic, R. Gradient-based learning of higher-order image features. International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV 2011).	2011
Susskind, J., Memisevic, R., Hinton, G., Pollefeys M. Modeling the joint density of two images under a variety of transformations. International Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR 2011).	2011
Memisevic, R. On spatio-temporal sparse coding: Analysis and an algorithm. NIPS workshop on deep learning and unsupervised feature learning.	2011
Memisevic, R., Conrad C. Stereopsis via deep learning. NIPS workshop on deep learning and unsupervised feature learning.	2011
Memisevic, R., Hinton, G. Learning to Represent Spatial Transformations with Factored Higher-Order Boltzmann Machines. Neural Computation. Vol. 22, No. 6: 1473-1492.	2010
Memisevic, R., Zach, C., Hinton, G., Pollefeys M. Gated Softmax Classification. Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS 2010).	2010
Sigal, L., Memisevic, R., Fleet, D. Shared Kernel Information Embedding for Discriminative Inference. International Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2009.	2009
Memisevic, R., Hinton, G. E. Unsupervised learning of image transformations. International Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2007.	2007
Samulowitz, H., Memisevic, R. Learning to solve QBF. Twenty-Second Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) 2007.	2007
Memisevic, R. Kernel Information Embeddings. International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2006.	2006
Memisevic, R. Propagating Errors and Beliefs for Large Scale Nonlinear Structure Prediction. North East Student Colloquium on Artificial Intelligence. Ithaca, NY.	2006
Meinicke, P., Klanke, S., Memisevic, R., Ritter, H. Principal Surfaces from Unsupervised Kernel Regression. IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (PAMI), Sep. 2005.	2005

Memisevic, R. and Hinton, G. E.	2005
Improving dimensionality reduction with spectral gradient descent.	
Neural Networks, 18, pp 702-710.	
Memisevic, R., Srebro N., Roweis, S.	2005
Exploring the regularization path for adaptive Gaussian kernel SVMs.	
NIPS Workshop on the Accuracy-Regularization Frontier.	
Memisevic, R.	2005
Dual Optimization of Conditional Probability Models.	
NIPS Workshop on Kernel Methods for Structured Domains.	
Memisevic, R. and Hinton, G. E.	2005
Embedding via clustering: Using spectral information to guide dimensionality reduction.	
International Joint Conference on Neural Networks 2005.	
Memisevic, R. and Hinton, G. E.	2005
Multiple Relational Embedding.	
Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS) 2005.	
THESES	
Memisevic, R.	2008
Non-linear latent factor models for revealing structure in high-dimensional data.	
PhD Thesis, Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto.	
Memisevic, R.	2003
Unsupervised Kernel Regression for Nonlinear Dimensionality Reduction.	
Master's thesis, Department of Computer Science, Bielefeld University.	
SELECTED TALKS	
Workshop on NLP in the Era of Generative AI, Cognitive Sciences, and Societal Transformation	
Invited talk "End-to-end learning of camera-based, situated interactions"	MILA, Montreal 2024
Qualcomm webinar "Integrating senses: how AI is learning to see, hear, and interact"	Sep. 2024
ISCAS 2017 Invited talk	Baltimore May 2017
Re-Work Deep Learning Summit 2017 Invited talk	San Francisco Jan. 2017
MIT Deep Learning workshop 2016 Invited talk	Boston Jun. 2016
ICISP 2016 Keynote	Trois Rivieres Jun. 2016
Re-Work Deep Learning Summit 2016 Invited talk	San Francisco Jan. 2016
Data science meetup Berlin Invited talk	Berlin Nov. 2015
University of Toronto Invited seminar, CS department	Toronto Nov. 2015
KLA-Tencor Invited talk	Monterey Oct. 2015
Google Invited talk	Mountain View Oct. 2015
ICML 2015 workshop on Deep Learning Invited talk	Lille July 2015
Universite Laval Invited talk Dept. for Comp. Sci. and Software Engineering	Quebec Apr. 2015
Data science day Invited talk	Berlin Oct. 2014
ICLR 2014 Keynote	Banff Apr. 2014

Max-Planck Institute for Biological Cybernetics Invited talk	Tuebingen Aug. 2011
Learning the meaning of “the same” , University of Basel.	Basel Aug. 2010
How to train a mixture of 100.000.000.000.000.000 classifiers. , Univ. of Toronto.	May 2010
Learning to encode data transformations. , ETH Zürich.	Sep. 2009
Extrahieren verborgener Strukturen mit latenten Variablen. , TU Darmstadt.	Sep. 2009
Learning with factorized three-way interactions. , CIFAR workshop on inter-neurons.	Apr. 2008
Learning the allowable transformations of simple shapes using 3-way interactions. , CIFAR workshop on 'Achieving perceptual invariance'.	Dec. 2007
Building a compact multi-resolution index structure. , Microsoft Research.	Sep. 2007
Learning with conditional latent variables. , Yahoo! Applied Research Montreal.	June 2007
Learning with conditional latent variables. , TradeLink Holdings, Chicago.	May 2007
Unsupervised learning of image transformations. , CIFAR Summer School.	Aug. 2006
Kernel information embeddings , University of Toronto.	Sep. 2005
Kernel information embeddings. CIFAR Workshop on Manifold Learning.	Apr. 2005

GRANTS AND AWARDS

FQRNT Team Research Project: Unsupervised deep learning of changes in facial expression 2015 $\approx$ \$150,000 CAD four three years. Team leader, with co-PIs Yoshua Bengio, Pascal Vincent, Aaron Courville.

DARPA seedling project 2015
 $\approx$ \$180,000 USD for one year for studying Deep Learning based time series models (PI) jointly with Yoshua Bengio (co-PI). Part of a larger project with SRI and University of Guelph.

Facebook 2014
\$25,000 USD, gift

Google faculty research award 2013
\$40,800 USD for studying phase-sensitive feature hierarchies.

NSERC Discovery Grant 2013
\$100,000 CAD (\$20,000 per year for five years 2013–2018) Research Grant.

NSERC Strategic Grant 2013
\$575,739 CAD (\$191,913 per year for three years) Strategic Project Grant in collaboration with Ubisoft (jointly with Yoshua Bengio, Pascal Vincent and Aaron Courville)

Government of Canada Award 2003
Funding for the first two years of my PhD program at Toronto ($>$ \$50.000 CAD in total)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Regular reviewer and/or PC member for conferences ICLR, NIPS, ICML, CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, DAGM

Reviewer for Swiss National Science Foundation, Journal IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (PAMI), Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR), Journal Image and Vision Computing (IMAVIS), Journal Constraint, Journal Machine Learning, IEEE Transactions on Image Processing, International Journal of Adaptive Control and Signal Processing.

Co-organizer for CRM/CIFAR Summer School on Deep Learning in Montreal 2015 (with Yoshua Bengio, Yann LeCun)

Co-organizer for NIPS 2014 workshop on Deep Learning and Representation Learning (with Adam Coates, Yoshua Bengio, Andrew Ng)

Invited tutorial on Deep Learning at *Hotchips* (Cupertino, CA) 2015

Invited tutorial on Deep Learning in Image Processing and Vision at International Conference on Image Processing *ICIP* (Quebec City) 2015

Invited tutorial at Training Workshop on Deep Architectures in Vision and NL (Wroclaw, Poland) 2015

Invited tutorial at the *CIFAR Summer School Neural Computation and Adaptive Perception (NCAP)* Toronto 2013

Tutorial at CVPR 2012: *Multiview feature learning*

Invited tutorial at the *IPAM Graduate Summer School: Deep Learning, Feature Learning* (UCLA) 2012

Invited tutorial at DAGM 2011: *Higher-order feature learning: Building a computer vision “swiss army knife”*

GRADUATE STUDENT SUPERVISION

Zhouhan Lin (PhD student at University of Montreal, from 2014)

Vincent Michalski (PhD student at University of Montreal, from 2015)

Harm de Vries (PhD student at University of Montreal, from 2014) jointly with Aaron Courville

Kyle Kastner (MSc student at University of Montreal, from 2014) jointly with Yoshua Bengio

David Krueger (MSc student at University of Montreal, from 2013) jointly with Yoshua Bengio

Kishore Konda (University of Frankfurt) PhD received 2015

Sebastien Jean (University of Montreal) MSc received 2015

Vincent Michalski (University of Frankfurt) MSc received 2014

Irina Shelegeda (University of Frankfurt) MSc received 2014

Hanna Kamyschanska (University of Frankfurt) MSc received 2013

Felix Bauer (University of Frankfurt) MSc received 2012

TEACHING

Instructor, <i>Machine Learning for Vision (IFT 6268)</i> University of Montreal	Winter 2016
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Instructor, <i>Databases (IFT2821)</i> University of Montreal	Winter 2015
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Instructor, <i>Machine Learning for Vision (IFT 6268)</i> University of Montreal	Winter 2015
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Instructor, <i>Fundamentals of Machine Learning</i> University of Montreal	Fall 2014
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Instructor, <i>Machine Learning for Vision (IFT 6268)</i> University of Montreal	Fall 2013
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Instructor, <i>Topics in artificial intelligence (IFT 6085): Visual Feature Learning</i> University of Montreal	Winter 2013
Instructor, <i>Machine Learning</i> University of Frankfurt	Winter 2011/12
Instructor, <i>Digital Image Processing</i> University of Frankfurt	Spring 2011
Teaching Assistant, <i>Introduction to Neural Networks and Machine Learning (CSC 321)</i> University of Toronto	Spring 06/07
Teaching Assistant, <i>Software Design (CSC 207)</i> , University of Toronto	Summer 2006
Teaching Assistant, <i>Machine Learning (CSC 2515)</i> , University of Toronto	Fall 2005 and 2006
Teaching Assistant, <i>Theoretical Computer Science</i> , Bielefeld University	Summer 2000
Teaching Assistant, <i>Methods of Artificial Intelligence</i> , Bielefeld University	Winter 1999/2000